

1.3 Pre-production and planning documentation and techniques for digital games

Game concepts

- Idea generation
- Pre-production documents to illustrate game concepts
 - reference art and concept art
 - unique selling point
 - objectives

To include:

- What is meant by the term 'game concept'
- What constitutes 'derivative' game ideas (as opposed to original games)
- Devising original game concepts
- Devising and setting out narratives or sets of objectives for original game concepts
- Using pre-production documentation to outline game concepts to clients (as distinct from those needed by the developer or programmer)

Does not include:

- Investigation of existing games as a separate research activity
- Design constraints and opportunities in terms of availability of development timescales, costs, distribution channels and marketing/release/promotion

Game planning

- Pre-production documentation and planning for digital game appearance
 - concept art
- Pre-production documentation and planning for digital game structure
 - flowcharts
 - decision trees
 - narrative pathways
 - story arc
- Techniques for planning digital game mechanics
 - scoring mechanisms
 - measures of success/ completion/ progression through the game
- Concept of MVP (minimal viable product)

To include:

- Using concept art to show overall visual style and style and appearance of elements including player characters, NPCs, objects, terrains/scenery/rooms, start screens/menu options
- Creating flowcharts/decision trees/narrative pathways/story arcs to plan structures by indicating choices for gameplay/different routes or pathways through digital games
- Planning how scoring mechanisms are displayed and integrated within the visuals of digital games and how feedback to players is provided during gameplay. Documentation (prose/diagrammatic) to include:
 - flowcharts
 - if-then/input-output tables/diagrams
 - narrative/description of story arc
- Applying the concept of MVP (Minimum Viable Product) when planning digital games to ensure audience engagement

Does not include:

- Any form of project management planning documentation including workplans and Gantt charts